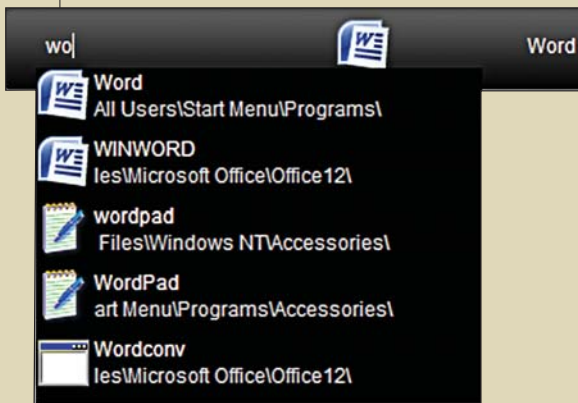




Launchy's in-line search capabilities in action

LAUNCHY

www.launchy.net

Here's a lightweight open source program to quickly open any file on your computer. It's as unobtrusive as possible: it's invisible. Press [Alt] + [Space] and it pops up. So here's the idea: say you want to open an Excel file buried where no mouse has gone before, begin entering the name of your desired file in the Launchy window, and possible matches will come up. Home in on your file and launch it right from the Launchy window—hence the name!

The program learns from past keystrokes, so as you keep using it, you'll find you need to press fewer keys before you find your file. Even if Launchy doesn't find a matching file, it will show you a list of all files that somewhat match what you've typed.

Now Launchy doesn't do black magic (or, to be racially neutral, blue magic). It indexes files, of course. To be able to find files of a certain extension, you need to first index those: for example, if you add the .EXE extension, programs will be indexed. In addition, stuff in the Start Menu is indexed by default.

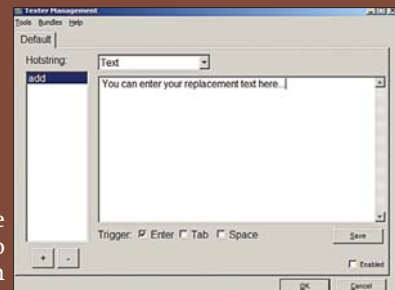
If you're using this popular program at your workplace, you can index files on your intranet as well. Find Launchy on our March 2007 DVD.

TEXTER

http://tinyurl.com/2ww36b

Those things in Word like "December (Press Enter to Insert)" are more of a pain in the behind than anything else. What you need is Texter to enter oft-used text (hence the name). So just assign a word like "addr" to a block of text—like your address—and when you type in "addr", your address is all typed out for you. This saves time, and more importantly, relieves the frustration of doing mindless things.

For the programmers out there: apart from basic text replacement, Texter has a set of predefined variables you can use to generate dynamic content (like the current date). For example, %| will assign the place to where the cursor should return to after text is replaced, as in, if you create a



Adding Hoststrings in Texter

macro with the text block "Digit %| Is The Coolest", the cursor will position itself between "Digit" and "Is". Typing "{Tab}" will insert a tab where you need it. You can even combine variables.

Just to give you an idea of what Texter can do, you can highlight text and paste it elsewhere without having to do a copy-paste operation. You'd have to construct a simple macro: "^c %c {Space}". Here, "%c" is a predefined variable that means "paste clipboard contents along with a pre-defined block of text" to Texter.

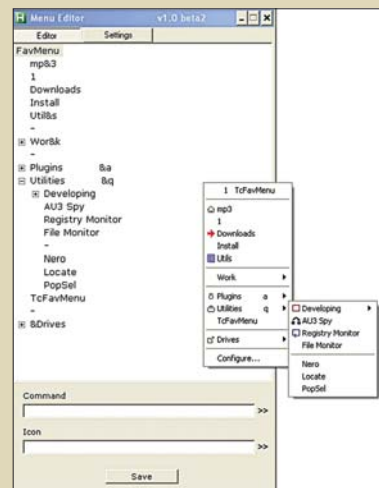
Find Texter on our August 2007 CD.

AUTOHOTKEY

www.autohotkey.com

Now if you need macros for just about any action, you need AutoHotKey. You could use it to replace blocks of text, but going beyond, you could do things like open your browser and several sites under tabs, make multiple directories, and shut down your computer after a download or copy action—in the blink of an eye. AutoHotKey, as you can see, takes macros to a new level.

The program incorporates another one called AutoScriptWriter, which allows you to record macros. These can then be replayed. So you start up this program, press Record, do various actions, and press Stop. Then, playing back the macro will do all those various actions. We created a macro to capture screenshots and save them with IrfanView, in the .TIFF format, on the Desktop. Behind the scenes, Auto-



Looks difficult, but is very easy to use

ScriptWriter creates a macro file that contains the code for what is to be done. Find that macro—and the program itself—on our May 2007 CD.

Naturally, you can write your own macros. Learn about it at www.autohotkey.com/wiki/index.php?title=AHK_Tutorial.

UPDATE CHECKER

www.filehippo.com/updatechecker

If you like to have all your software updated down to the last decimal, this little tool is most certainly for you. Update Checker runs a quick scan on all the programs on your computer, then opens up a Web page and tells you which ones can be upgraded.



The fastest way to find program updates

It's not magic: the Update Checker Web site maintains a version number database of programs along with download information, which registered users can

update. Upon a scan, Update Checker compares the version numbers there to those of the programs it finds. Next, a Web page with the download information for the new

version is opened.

Find Update Checker on this month's CD. Update Checker runs on even Windows 98, provided you have .NET 2.0 framework installed.